Information For the Use of
Voriconazole (200mg) Tablets

Voricole 200 Tablet

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Composition:

Each tablet contains:

- **Voriconazole** – 200 mg

Pharmacological Action:

Voriconazole is a **broad-spectrum triazole antifungal agent** that inhibits fungal cell membrane synthesis.

- **Ergosterol Inhibition:** Inhibits fungal cytochrome P450-dependent enzyme **lanosterol 14α-demethylase**, reducing ergosterol synthesis.
- **Cell Membrane Disruption:** Depletion of ergosterol compromises fungal cell membrane integrity and function.
- **Broad Antifungal Activity:** Active against several clinically important pathogenic fungi, including **Aspergillus** and **Candida** species.
- **Fungicidal/Fungistatic Activity:** Activity varies according to the fungal species and concentration.

Indications:

Voricole 200 Tablet is indicated for the treatment of serious fungal infections, including:

- **Invasive Aspergillosis**
- **Invasive Candidiasis** in selected patients
- **Serious infections caused by Scedosporium species**
- **Serious infections caused by Fusarium species**
- Other susceptible invasive fungal infections as determined by a specialist

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Dosage and Administration:

- **Recommended Dose:** Dosage is individualized according to the infection, body weight, age, hepatic function, and clinical response.
- In adults, treatment commonly involves a **loading dose followed by a maintenance dose**, as prescribed by the physician.
- Tablets may be taken **at least 1 hour before or 1 hour after meals** for optimal absorption.

- Swallow the tablet whole with water.
- Maintain the prescribed dosing interval and do not skip doses.
- Treatment duration depends on the type and severity of infection and the patient's clinical response.
- **Therapeutic drug monitoring (TDM)** may be recommended, particularly in prolonged treatment, severe infection, drug interactions, or variable response.

Precautions:

- Voriconazole is associated with **hepatic toxicity**; liver function tests should be monitored during treatment.
- May cause **visual disturbances**, particularly shortly after administration. Patients should avoid driving or operating machinery if vision is affected.
- May cause **photosensitivity**; use appropriate sun protection during prolonged treatment.
- Long-term treatment may rarely be associated with **cutaneous squamous cell carcinoma**, particularly in patients with significant photosensitivity.
- Voriconazole may prolong the **QT interval** and should be used cautiously in patients with risk factors for cardiac arrhythmias.
- Dose adjustment or careful monitoring may be required in patients with **hepatic impairment**.
- Oral tablets are generally preferred according to the prescribed regimen; dosing must be individualized in renal impairment.
- **Pregnancy:** Use only when the potential benefit justifies the potential risk.
- **Lactation:** Breastfeeding should generally be avoided during treatment unless specifically advised by the physician.

Contraindications:

- Known hypersensitivity to **voriconazole or other triazole antifungal agents**.
- Concomitant use with certain medicines that can cause serious or potentially life-threatening interactions with voriconazole, including some **CYP3A4 substrates and QT-prolonging medicines**.
- Severe hypersensitivity to any component of the formulation.

Adverse Reactions:

Common:

- Visual disturbances
- Headache
- Nausea
- Vomiting
- Diarrhea
- Abdominal discomfort

- Rash
- Fever

Less Common but Serious:

- **Hepatotoxicity**
- QT prolongation and serious cardiac arrhythmias
- Severe skin reactions
- Photosensitivity reactions
- Severe hypersensitivity reactions
- Neurological effects such as hallucinations or confusion
- Pancreatitis
- Renal impairment

Seek immediate medical attention for jaundice, severe rash or blistering, fainting, severe palpitations, difficulty breathing, or significant visual or neurological changes.

Drug Interactions:

Voriconazole has **extensive and clinically important drug interactions**.

- **Rifampicin, rifabutin, carbamazepine, and long-acting barbiturates** may substantially reduce voriconazole concentrations and are generally contraindicated.
- **Ritonavir** and certain other potent enzyme inducers may markedly reduce voriconazole exposure.
- **Warfarin:** Voriconazole may increase anticoagulant effect; monitor **PT/INR** closely.
- **Cyclosporine and tacrolimus:** Voriconazole may substantially increase their concentrations; dose adjustment and therapeutic monitoring are required.
- **Sirolimus:** Concomitant use is generally contraindicated because voriconazole can markedly increase sirolimus exposure.
- **Certain statins, benzodiazepines, calcium-channel blockers, and sulfonylureas** may have increased exposure.
- **QT-prolonging medicines** may increase the risk of serious cardiac arrhythmias.
- Patients should inform their physician about all prescription medicines, OTC medicines, herbal preparations, and supplements before starting treatment.

Storage:

- Store in a cool, dry place below **25°C**, unless otherwise specified by the approved product label.
- Protect from moisture, direct sunlight, and excessive heat.
- Keep tablets in the original blister/packaging until use.
- Keep out of reach of children.

Note:

This information is intended as a general prescribing guide. **Voricole 200 Tablet should be prescribed and monitored by a physician experienced in the treatment of serious fungal infections.** Dosage should be individualized according to the organism, site and severity of infection, body weight, hepatic function, and clinical response.

Important: Voriconazole has a **high potential for drug interactions** and a relatively narrow therapeutic range. **Liver function monitoring and therapeutic drug monitoring may be appropriate**, particularly during prolonged therapy or when interacting medicines are being used.

Manufactured in India for:

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LIFECARE

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